

home with something less tangible, but ultimately more valuable. Despite standing nearly five inches taller, she struggled to land clean punches or sustained combinations. The post-mortem was clear. Against shorter opponents, she needed to abandon caution, step into exchanges, and use her reach as a weapon rather than a buffer.

The adjustment was evident when she was selected for July's World Boxing Cup in Astana. After two evenly matched rounds, Jaismine began asserting control with her long jab and straight punches, edging past two-time Olympian Jucielen Romeu of Brazil 4-1 in the final.

Two months later, at the World Championships in Liverpool, she delivered a lesson in control and consistency. Four successive 5-0 unanimous victories followed, including a commanding win over Venezuelan Olympian Omailyn Alcala.

The sternest examination arrived in the final against Poland's Julia Szeremeta, the Paris 2024 silver medallist.

Even after conceding the opening round, Jaismine stayed composed, using superior footwork and crisp counters to wrest control and seal a 4-1 split decision (30-27, 29-28, 30-27, 28-29, 29-28). The win made her the ninth Indian woman to claim a world title.

There was little pause. In November, at the World Boxing Cup Finals in Greater Noida, Jaismine fought through intense pain in her left shoulder to defeat Kazakhstan's former Asian youth champion Ulzhan Sarsenbek 5-0. That victory set up a marquee final against Paris Olympic bronze medallist Wu Shih Yi. Unable to deploy her favoured left hook, Jaismine adapted again, relying on disciplined right jabs and straight lefts to record a 4-1 win.

By the end of the season, Jaismine Lamboria's body of work stood as a reaffirmation of Indian women's place in global boxing, built not on hype, but on adjustment, resilience, and control.

Santadeep Dey



Lamboria